

played for India despite performing so well. Over the last 5–6 years, I’ve taken 200 wickets, and Saurashtra has won the Ranji Trophy twice. But I must focus on my work and not dwell on it too much,” said Dharmendrasinh. The two Jadejas have rarely played together due to Ravindra’s India commitments. However, Saurashtra has been nearly invincible in the matches where they have joined forces.

“Whenever Jaddu bhai plays for Saurashtra, it’s a great experience. You learn a lot from his bowling — how to build pressure, which field placements to use, and other nuances. I can’t bowl as quickly through the air as him, but he understands what works for me and helps accordingly,” Dharmendrasinh added.

Stadium that does it all

It is not uncommon for a place to be referred to by two names. The International Cricket Stadium in Thiruvananthapuram is no exception, alternatively known as the Greenfield or the Sports Hub. The name Greenfield seems more fitting, as the stadium is nestled in the heart

of vast greenery. The term Sports Hub, on the other hand, feels more like what a corporate entity might call its table tennis room.

Nevertheless, Greenfield Stadium and I go way back — I did my schooling just a few kilometres from the stadium and recall watching its construction from a distance over a decade ago.

Thus, a visit to Greenfield to cover the Ranji Trophy match between Kerala and Madhya Pradesh felt like a professional homecoming.

Another thing to note about Greenfield is that it’s a true all-rounder. In addition to world-class cricketing facilities, Greenfield boasts a fully functioning movie multiplex, making it probably the only cricket stadium in the world to guarantee blockbuster action even on days without a match.

The stadium also boasts a large convention centre, which hosted a dog show on the final day of the Ranji match. In fact, the event drew a crowd far larger than the one that

Gun player: Ravindra Jadeja’s all-round heroics powered Saurashtra to a bonus-point victory over Delhi in just two days. VIJAY SONEJI

watched Kerala fight for a priceless draw, nearly securing a spot in the Ranji knockout phase for the first time in six years. Sigh!

A red-letter day

As the cricketers from Jammu and Kashmir celebrated their historic victory over Mumbai, Indian cricket legend Sachin Tendulkar personally approached the team manager to extend his heartfelt congratulations on their remarkable triumph — a victory that marked their first over the domestic giants in more than a decade.

Tendulkar, who was training at the MCA-BKC club ahead of a tournament featuring former cricketers, was joined by former India international Irfan Pathan, who previously served as a mentor to the J&K side.

During his tenure, Pathan played a pivotal role in nurturing talents like Abdul Samad and Umran Malik, who have since risen to prominence at both domestic and international levels.

“To defeat a star-studded Ranji champion like Mumbai on their home turf is no small feat. Congratulations to the J&K team, coaching staff, and support staff for scripting history. The ‘God of Cricket’, Tendulkar, personally congratulated our manager,” said JKCA administrator Brig. Anil Gupta.

Currently leading the points table, J&K will face Baroda in its final group-stage fixture next week.

All for Rohit

Large crowds had gathered at the MCA-BKC ground to catch a glimpse of India captain Rohit Sharma in action. Although Rohit endured a disappointing outing for Mumbai, fans passionately chanted “Mumbai chya Raja, Rohit Sharma” whenever they spotted him on the field. The cricketer graciously interacted with his supporters, signing autographs and taking selfies.

A fan even breached security in a bid to meet Rohit, sprinting onto the field to touch his feet. Before being escorted away by security personnel, the fan managed a brief conversation with the star cricketer.

Shayan Acharya, Pranay Rajiv and Vivek Krishnan



SAURASHTRA HAS BEEN NEARLY INVINCIBLE IN THE MATCHES WHERE THE TWO JADEJAS - RAVINDRA AND DHARMENDRASINH - HAVE JOINED FORCES